

Security Automation Operations Runbook

Safe execution, review, approval, rollback, logging, and maintenance of security automation

Pre-Run

- Confirm script version, owner, purpose, input file, output destination, and required permissions.
- Run against non-production or test data first when logic has changed.
- Use dry-run mode when supported and review proposed changes.
- Back up or version-control mutable configuration before changes.

Execution

- Use least-privileged service/user context.
- Capture stdout/stderr and write structured logs where appropriate.
- Stop on unexpected input, missing dependencies, or permission errors rather than silently skipping critical steps.
- Never hard-code secrets in scripts or repository files.

Post-Run Validation

- Compare input/output counts and review removed/changed entries.
- Validate system behavior after configuration automation.
- Retain summary/log evidence with case/change reference.
- Escalate unexpected removals, security-control failures, or partial execution.

Rollback

- Restore the versioned prior file/configuration if validation fails.
- Document why rollback occurred and preserve failed-run evidence for troubleshooting.
- Do not re-run repeatedly until root cause is understood if repeated runs could worsen state.

Maintenance

- Review dependencies and interpreter versions.
- Update tests when logic changes.
- Track false positives/edge cases from operational use.
- Assign an owner for approved-network lists, allowlists, and environment baselines.
- Document deprecation when automation is replaced.